VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

The First World War

Lecture - 01

By – Kunal Sir



Topics *to be covered*

1. Nationalism and Imperialism
2. Race For Armaments
3. Division of Europe Into Two Hostile Groups
4. Immediate Cause

Causes of First World War



Swagat Hai Cheems Gang Ka



3. The Contemporary World

(a) The First World War

Causes (Nationalism and Imperialism, Armament Race, division of Europe and Sarajevo crisis) and Results (Treaty of Versailles, territorial rearrangements, formation of League of Nations).

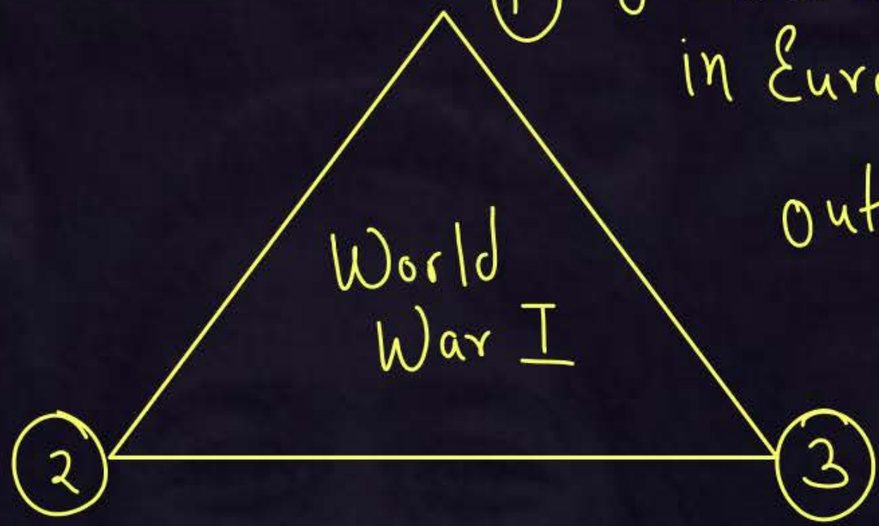
Ques The WW I was fought between?

(a) 1939-45

(b) 1916-1919

(c) 1914-1918

(d) 1920-1921



1. It was a war fought in Europe and outside it (Africa, Asia)

2. It was a modern industrial war

3. It was destructive

CAUSES OF THE WWI

Nationalism and Imperialism

1. Nationalism refers to the sense of unity felt by the people, who share a common history, language and culture.

3. People of many countries believe that their country is superior to others .

Nationalism and Imperialism

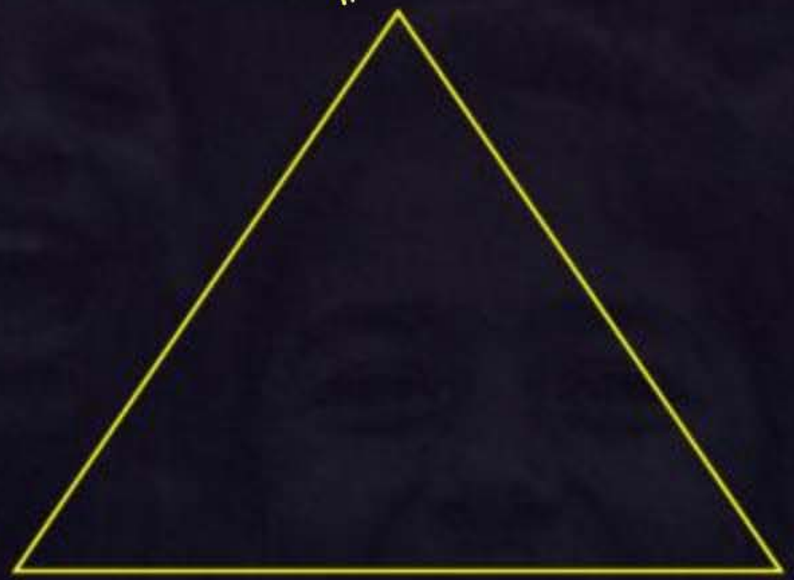
2. Later Half 19th century –this feeling of unity turned into extreme pride

4. This led to development of aggressive nationalism in Europe

- Each nation thought about its own national interests and did not care for the interests of the other nations.



1. France wanted to get back its provinces of Alsace and Lorraine from Germany.





2. Italy wanted to get back the territory of Trentino Trieste from Austria

3. Balkan States like Serbia wanted that their fellow nationals (Slavs) who lived in other States should come together to form a greater Balkan State

- These countries developed expansionist policies in the name of nationalism.
- So military strength was now being connected with national prestige
- Countries started increasing their military power .

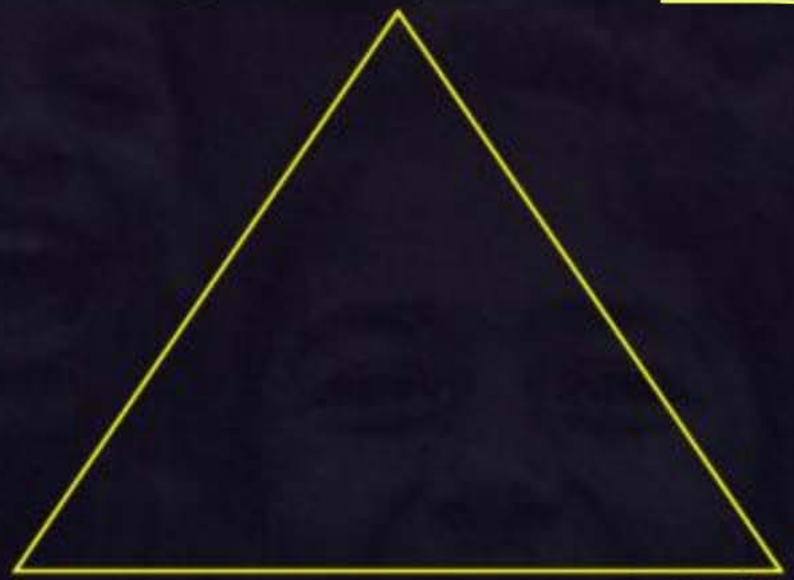
Aggressive nationalism also led to the rise of imperialism



Imperialism

- Imperialism refers to the state policy or practice by which a powerful nation establishes its control over another country, either by direct territorial acquisition or by gaining political and economic control.
- Once conquered, this country was claimed as a colony.

1.These colonies were governed and administered by the imperial nation through its representatives or a puppet government.



2.The imperial nations exploited the resources of these colonies for their own economic interest

3.Colonies provided raw material, cheap labour, agricultural land and trading ports to the imperial nations.

By the end of the 19th century, England and France had built up a huge colonial empire in Asia and Africa.



British imperialism was focused on maintaining and expanding trade by exploiting the resources of its colonies-



India, Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Egypt, South Africa, Caribbean Islands and many parts of Africa.

1. Britain's imperial power was supported by her powerful and the world's largest navy.

3. Colonies important- provided raw material for industries and market for finished goods. Also add to power and prestige



2. Some other countries like Germany, Italy, Russia and Japan also wanted to increase their influence and create their colonies in Asia and Africa.

4 This led to clash of interest . European powers began to expand their economic and political empire

Thus, aggressive nationalism and fierce economic competition filled the atmosphere with :

- Fear
- mutual hatred
- international tension.

- People felt convinced that international problems could only be solved through militarism.

Ques

Who among the following had world's largest navy before WWI ?

(a) Turkey

(b) Britain

(c) France

(d) USA



Race for Armaments

↳ weapons

1.The mad race for armaments began soon after the Franco-Prussian War (1870) was one of the reasons which led to the First World War.

2.Every major power began collecting armaments in the name of self-defense and preservation of peace



3.If one country increased its armaments, other countries also did the same .Mutual tension, fear and hatred increased

4. In order to protect her colonies in Africa and a few islands in the Pacific, Germany began to build a powerful navy with a view to achieving equality with Britain



By 1914, Germany had left Britain and France far behind in the production of iron and steel and in many other manufactures.

One of its ships, the Imperator, built in 1912 was the largest in the world.

The Germans dug the Kiel Canal deeper so that battleships could enter its waters.

Britain and France were concerned with Germany's growing military strength.

This led to a fierce competition among the European countries and gave rise to the race for armaments.

Division of Europe into Two Hostile Groups

Division of Europe into Two Hostile Groups:

- There were two kinds of States in Europe in the early 20th century.

- On the one hand there were single Nation-States like France, Holland and Germany whose national identities were based on their common language and traditions

- On the other, there were imperial States like the Austria-Hungarian Empire and the Russian Empire.

- The Austria-Hungarian Empire was ruled by the Habsburg dynasty of Austria
- It included Hungary, Serbia, Bosnia and Croatia
- Population spoke different languages and had different cultural traditions.

- Germany entered into an alliance with Austria-Hungary.
- In 1882 Italy joined the alliance and it came to be known as the Triple Alliance.

- After the death of Bismarck, France was able to establish friendly relations with Russia and England.
- The Russian empire included territories populated by Polish, Ukrainian, Turkish and Mongol populations.
- The three countries entered into the Triple Entente in 1907 to counter the Triple Alliance.
- Later Japan joined the Triple Entente. Thus, Europe was divided into two hostile camps.

- Britain had created a vast British Empire by acquiring colonies in Asia and Africa. It grew rich from its success in trade in foreign resources, markets, territories and people.
- Other countries of the world like Germany, the Netherlands, Italy and the USA too wanted to acquire colonies in Asia and Africa.
- This led to a fight for colonies and therefore, rivalries and wars.
- Rivalries between nations happened not just for colonies but for colonial trade and trade routes as well.
- These rivalries created suspicion, tension and wars, which finally started the First World War.

Capital → Bosnia

Sarajevo Crisis (Immediate Cause)

Sarajevo Crisis (Immediate Cause):

Archduke Francis Ferdinand, the heir to the throne of Austria-Hungary was assassinated at Sarajevo, capital of Bosnia on June 28, 1914.

Kill

Assassination - organised by a secret society called 'Black Hand' or 'Union of Death' formed by extremist Serbian nationalists who wanted to create State Single Serbian State

Austria served a warning to Serbia on July 23 making eleven demands. Serbia accepted most demands except the one that would take away its sovereignty

Sarajevo Crisis (Immediate Cause):

1. Austria declared war on Serbia on July 28, 1914.
2. Russia started preparation for war to support Serbia.
3. On August 1, 1914 Germany declared war on Russia; and on August 3, on France.
4. German troops marched into Belgium to press on to France on August 4 and on the same day Britain declared war on Germany.



Ques

_____ was not the cause of WW I

(a) Nationalism and Imperialism

(b) Race for Armaments

(c) Assassination of Franz Ferdinand

(d) Treaty of Versailles

Ques

_____ is a policy where nations compete to stockpile weapons.

(a) Race For Armaments

(b) Imperialism

(c) Colonialism

(d) Both b & c

1. Many other countries soon entered the War. Japan declared war on Germany to capture German colonies in the Far East.



WWI.
Allied
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2.Turkey and Bulgaria joined on the side of Germany. Italy remained neutral for some time but joined the war against Germany in 1915 breaking the Triple Alliance.

3. Britain, France, Russia and their allies were called the Allied powers; while Germany, Austria and their allies were called the Central Powers.

Ques

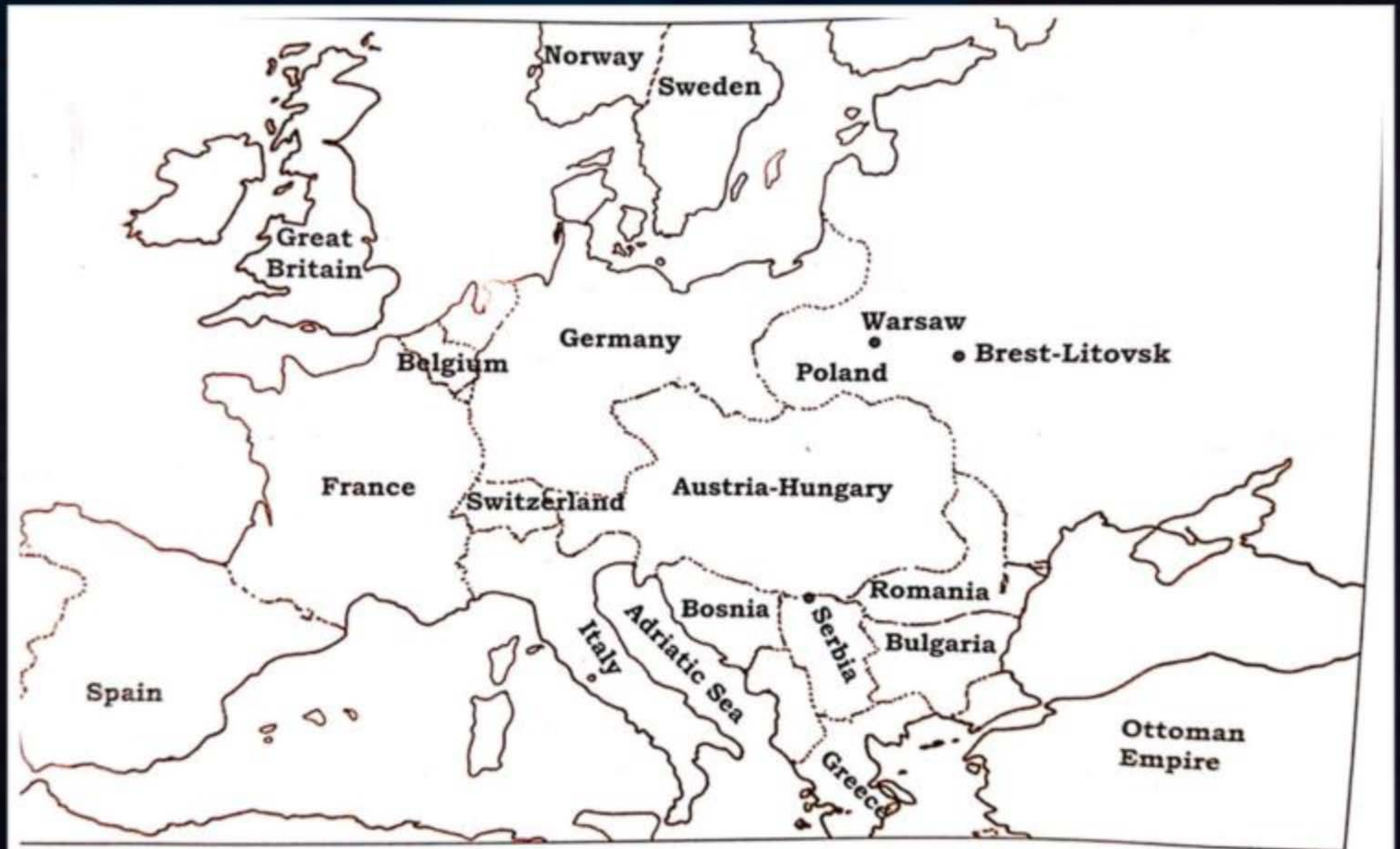
Who among the following was not an Allied power ?

(a) Russia
(b) France
(c) England
(d) Ottoman Turkey

1. The War was fought in many different areas called fronts.

2. There was a Western Front between Germany and northern France, and an Eastern Front between Germany and the Russian forces.

3. There was fighting at sea and in the Middle East, where the Allied Powers attacked the Ottoman Empire.



Europe in 1914



Summary

Happy Rakshabandhan

from T-REX and Dogesh Squad



Homework From VICTORY Module

Ques Discuss two causes that led to WWI ?


Thank You